sense. If the market is rising after an upward breakout, those patterns with downward breakouts will struggle to see price drop. It's like trying to swim against the current.

Failures over time. Failures have increased over the three decades for both upward and downward breakout directions. That's not a good omen for future performance.

Table 11.9 shows busted pattern performance. See the Glossary (“Busted pattern”) for details on what a busted pattern looks like and how to spot one. Don't forget your binoculars.

Busted patterns count. Almost half (47%) of broadening tops will bust in bull markets after downward breakouts. Notice that the fewest busted patterns happen after downward breakouts in bear markets. There you have the market current (downward) carrying along price as it drops after a downward breakout. The sample count, at 30, is tiny compared to the some of the others.

Busted occurrence. I counted the types of busts (single, double, or more than two) and found that single busts happen most often. In second place for downward breakouts is triple (or more) busts.

Busted and non-busted performance. I compared the performance of all busts (one, two, and triple+) with single busted and patterns that don't bust (non-busted). Busted patterns outperform when the busted breakout direction matches the market trend (upward breakout in bull markets and downward breakout in bear markets).